

Most Authentic You: Confidence, Charisma & Assertiveness

Myth Busting

- A lot of people believe that feeling anxious in certain public settings is unique to them but this is one of the most common sources of anxiety in the world. You are not alone!
- We often fear people's reactions to us when we communicate clearly our needs, wants and emotions but the truth is that the more we conceal them the more painful life can be.
- Charisma is not a god given gift. Please think about a group of friends or one particular friend with whom you are particularly comfortable being yourself around. Chances are this is an example of your unique charisma as you are not filtering yourself.

Speaking Confidently

- We are all on a different point of the journey. One of you may want to just develop more confidence when selling your ideas to a small number of people at work. In this case, baby steps like small talk with your boss, then suggesting a performance improvement at work and finally requesting a performance appraisal would be logical approach. Somebody else might want to speak at a conference and in their scenario, they should look for an opportunity to lead a group meeting at work, potentially even join toastmasters and finally practice their performance on a small audience before the conference.
- Learn from the referenced performer Eimear McGeown who went out on stage to perform very confidently as she focussed on the 3 p's – plan (organising practices), prepare (execute your practice meticulously) and perform (take confidence knowing you have done your best in the lead up).

Your Unique Charisma

- Some people find a benefit to a few glasses of wine is that it helps loosen their tongue a little bit and provides some Dutch courage. We don't need alcohol to help us be ourselves, instead it involves being a little more vulnerable in our communication with potentially great returns.
- Simply start by smiling at people more (puts them at ease), a firm hand shake (don't worry if it's sweaty 😓) and having a few pre prepared conversation openers. Some examples of questions that might be good for you to reflect you answers on would be, what do you do for a living or where are you from? These questions can be answered bluntly or more openly to springboard a better conversation.
- Think about how you can open up conversations with good questions. An example is somebody who tells you their weekend was 'just ok' or 'pretty boring', then you could pry a little further with an open-ended question like, "do you like those boring kinds of weekends?" This will allow them to open up further if they wish and they may end up telling you about a pastime they really like doing on a normal weekend...

